[photo]

RUSSIAN TORTOISE

Testudo horsfieldii

HERBIVORE — Leafy Greens + Hay

WHAT THIS ANIMAL IS: Steppe herbivore — broadleaf greens dominant

SITES: Houston · SAA · Other

3-SEC CHECK Do I see mixed leafy greens?

STANDARD DIET — HEALTHY ANIMALS ONLY

Excludes sick / vet-care / special-diet animals

Covers ~95% of daily feedings. For the remaining 5%, use training and observation within sound science. Unsure — Pause. Ask. Escalate.

MORNING FEED-OUT

Grass hay pile only. No supplementation.

APPROX DAILY: ~80–120 g greens + hay ad-lib

ENCOUNTER / ENRICHMENT PORTION

Whole hay handfuls for hand-feeding. Nothing else.

CORRECT

Broadleaf greens + hay dominant

Dandelion greens

Collard greens

Kale

Romaine

Mulberry leaves

Grass hay

WRONG — FIX IMMEDIATELY

Fruit · Spinach · Iceberg · High-oxalate greens

Apple

Banana

Berries

Orange

SIMPLE BUILD

- 70–80% broadleaf greens
- 15% grass hay
- 5% browse/weeds (dandelion, plantain)
- Trace fruit only (occasional)

PREP RULE

Whole leaves. Rotate greens to prevent oxalate buildup. Fresh water daily. NO cruciferous excess (limit kale to 1–2x/week).

MATCH THE BOWL — DO NOT INTERPRET.

No photo = feeding not complete. · No substitutions without approval. · Unsure → Pause → Ask → Escalate.

Source: AZA Chelonian TAG + Testudo nutrition standards · Body-text extraction
LIFE Diet Governance System · v2026.04.23 · Match the bowl. Don't interpret.